

In the above configuration, 'screens' and 'links' are mandatory and 'aliases' are optional. The default syntax of any section is as follows:

```
section: name
arguments
end
```

Section names can be 'links', 'screens', 'aliases' or 'options'. Let us first understand the configuration file.

The first section is 'screens', which simply lists the names of the systems participating in the Synergy session. In our case, there are two systems and, hence, there are two entries. In this section, you can either use the hostname or IP address of the system.

The next section is 'aliases'. Synergy clients provide the hostname while establishing a connection with the server, so the server can find them in the configuration. Some systems report FQDN (Fully Qualified Domain Names) and some report only hostnames, depending on their network configuration. This section provides a list of names by which each computer is known. To describe this section, we can either use the IP address or the FQDN of the system. If you are using the FQDN in the 'screens' and 'links' section, then this section is optional.

Our last section is 'links'. This describes the virtual adjacency of the systems. If you remember, in the configuration, the Windows 7 machine is to the left of the Ubuntu machine or, you could say that the Ubuntu machine is on the right side of the Windows 7 machine. The 'links' section depicts this information. To know more about Synergy's configuration options, go through the details on <http://synergy2.sourceforge.net/configuration.html>.

Now let us test this configuration. On the Ubuntu machine, start the server in the foreground by using the following commands:

```
[bash]$ synergys --config ~/synergy.conf --no-daemon --no-restart
INFO: Synergy 1.5.1 Server on Linux 3.13.0-24-generic
#46-Ubuntu SMP Thu Apr 10 19:11:08 UTC 2014 x86_64
NOTE: started server, waiting for clients
```

Our server has started successfully and is waiting for the client connection. Here the '--no-restart' option implies: "Do not try to restart the server upon failure." Now switch to the client, i.e., Windows 7, and execute the following commands in the terminal:

```
[Windows CMD]$ cd "C:\Program Files\Synergy"
[Windows CMD]$ synergyc.exe --no-daemon --no-restart "xxx.xxx.xxx.xxx"
INFO: Synergy 1.5.1 Client on Microsoft Windows 7 x86
NOTE: started client
```

NOTE: connecting to 'xxx.xxx.xxx.xxx': xxx.xxx.xxx.xxx:24800

NOTE: connected to server

INFO: entering screen

INFO: leaving screen

Congratulate yourself; the connection has been established successfully. You should now be able to move the mouse between synergy sessions.



Note: For security reasons in the article, I have used 'x.x.x.x'. Do replace this with the actual IP address of your server machine.

One of the advantages of the text configuration is that we can copy it to another machine, and Synergy can be started by doing just a little modification. But some people prefer the GUI tool instead. No problem! Synergy also has an intuitive GUI tool from which you can configure the server, and there is also a GUI client. The section below illustrates the steps to configure the server using the GUI tool.

- 1) On the Ubuntu machine, first launch the Synergy application from *Unity dash*. The first two screens don't require any special attention.
 - 2) Select the server option from the third screen.
 - 3) Optionally, you can enable the encryption feature for Synergy. After that, click the 'Finish' button.
 - 4) From the main screen, ensure that the 'Configure Interactively' radio button is selected. Then click on the 'Configure Server' button.
 - 5) To add a new client, drag a new screen onto the grid from the spare ones at the upper right. By default, the name of the screen is shown as 'Unnamed'. To rename it, double click on it and give it an appropriate name. In my case, the name is 'windowspc'. Optionally, we can also define aliases on this screen.
 - 5) Similarly, to remove a client, drag the screen to the trash icon present in the upper left.
- Figure 2 shows what our configuration screen will look like. To activate the configuration, click the 'OK' button



Figure 2: Server configuration